



Before using this unit, carefully read "USING THE UNIT SAFELY" and "IMPORTANT NOTES" (the leaflet "USING THE UNIT SAFELY" and the Owner's Manual (p. 2)). After reading, keep the document(s) where it will be available for immediate reference.

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Owner's Manual (this document)

Read this first. It explains the basic things you need to know in order to use the TR-8S.



PDF Manual (download from the Web)

- **Reference Manual**
This provides a detailed explanation of how to use the TR-8S.
- **MIDI Implementation**
This is detailed information about MIDI messages.



To obtain the PDF manual

1. Enter the following URL in your computer.
<https://www.roland.com/support/>
2. On the Support menu, choose "Owner's Manuals."
3. Choose "TR-8S" as the product name.

USING THE UNIT SAFELY

WARNING

Use only the supplied AC adaptor and the correct voltage

Be sure to use only the AC adaptor supplied with the unit. Also, make sure the line voltage at the installation matches the input voltage specified on the AC adaptor's body. Other AC adaptors may use a different polarity, or be designed for a different voltage, so their use could result in damage, malfunction, or electric shock.



IMPORTANT NOTES

Placement

- Depending on the material and temperature of the surface on which you place the unit, its rubber feet may discolor or mar the surface.

Repairs and Data

- Before sending the unit away for repairs, be sure to make a backup of the data stored within it; or you may prefer to write down the needed information. Although we will do our utmost to preserve the data stored in your unit when we carry out repairs, in some cases, such as when the memory section is physically damaged, restoration of the stored content may be impossible. Roland assumes no liability concerning the restoration of any stored content that has been lost.

Additional Precautions

- Any data stored within the unit can be lost as the result of equipment failure, incorrect operation, etc. To protect yourself against the irretrievable loss of data, try to make a habit of creating regular backups of the data you've stored in the unit.
- Roland assumes no liability concerning the restoration of any stored content that has been lost.
- Never strike or apply strong pressure to the display.
- Continuous playing may cause discoloration of the pad, but this will not affect the pad's function.
- Do not use connection cables that contain a built-in resistor.

Using External Memories

- Please observe the following precautions when handling external memory devices. Also, make sure to carefully observe all the precautions that were supplied with the external memory device.
 - Do not remove the device while reading/writing is in progress.
 - To prevent damage from static electricity, discharge all static electricity from your person before handling the device.

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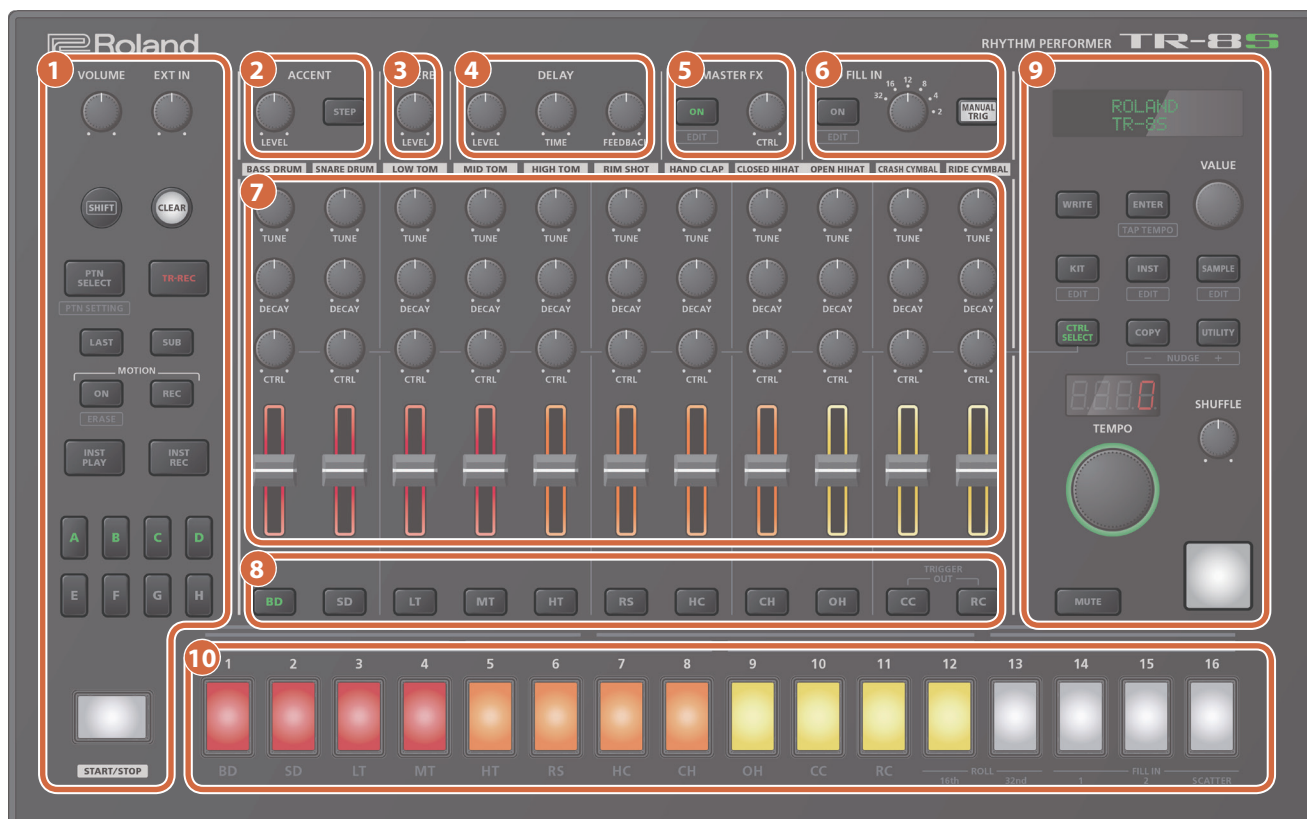
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Panel Descriptions

Top Panel



1 Common section 1

[VOLUME] knob

Adjusts the MIX OUT jack, PHONES jack's volume.

* This does not affect the volume of the ASSIGNABLE OUT jack (p. 7).

[EXT IN] knob

Adjusts the input volume from the EXT IN jacks.

[SHIFT] button

By holding down this button and operating certain other buttons, you can access a screen for making related settings.

If you edit a parameter value while holding down this button, the value will change more greatly.

[CLEAR] button

Erases the recorded content for an individual instrument, or deletes a pattern.

[PTN SELECT] button

Select a pattern.

page 9

[TR-REC] button

Step-records a pattern.

page 11

[LAST] button

Specifies the length of the pattern.

page 9

[SUB] button

Specifies duplets, triplets, or quadruplets as the step.

page 11

MOTION [ON] button

If this is ON, knob operation data (MOTION) is played back for each instrument.

page 11

MOTION [REC] button

If REC is selected, knob operation data (MOTION) is recorded for each instrument.

page 11

[INST PLAY] button

Use the pads [1]–[13] to perform in real time.

You can perform even while a pattern is playing.

[INST REC] button

Realtime-record a pattern.

page 12

[A]–[H] buttons

Switch pattern variations (A–H).

[START/STOP] button

Play or stop the pattern.

* If a sample is selected as the instrument's tone, the sound might not stop automatically depending on the instrument edit settings. While a pattern is stopped, you can silence all currently-sounding samples by holding down the [SHIFT] button and pressing the [START/STOP] button.

2 ACCENT section

page 11

Adds an accent to the specified step.

[LEVEL] knob

Adjusts the volume of the accent.

[STEP] button

During TR-REC, you can use pads [1]–[16] to select steps at which an accent is added.

3 REVERB section

page 10

[LEVEL] knob

Adjusts the volume of the reverb.

4 DELAY section

page 10

[LEVEL] knob

Adjusts the volume of the delay.

[TIME] knob

Adjusts the length of the delay.

[FEEDBACK] knob

Adjusts the amount of delay sound that is returned to the input.

5 MASTER FX section

page 15

[ON] button

Turns the master effect on/off.

[CTRL] knob

Controls the content specified by the master effect (p. 15).

6 AUTO FILL IN section

page 10

[ON] button

If this is on, a fill-in is inserted at the interval specified by the **[AUTO FILL IN]** knob.

[AUTO FILL IN] knob

Automatically inserts a fill-in at the specified interval of measures.

[MANUAL TRIG] button

Press this button to insert a fill-in.

7 INST edit section

Here you can adjust the tonal character of the instrument's tone.

[TUNE] knob

Adjusts the tuning (pitch).

[DECAY] knob

Adjusts the length of the decay.

[CTRL] knob

Controls the content specified by CTRL SELECT (p. 15).

* Depending on the tone, there might not be any effect.

Level fader

Adjusts the volume.

8 INST select buttons

During TR-REC, these buttons select the instrument that is recorded.

In the INST screen or INST Edit screen, these buttons select the instrument whose settings you want to edit.

In **[TR-REC]** or **[INST REC]**, you can hold down the **[CC]** button and press the **[RC]** button to input a pattern at which a trigger is output to the TRIGGER OUT jack (mini jack).

* This is not related to the ASSIGNABLE OUT/TRIGGER OUT jacks (phone jacks).

9 Common section 2**Display**

Shows pattern names and various settings.

[WRITE] button

Saves the pattern/kit/system settings.

page 18

* Parameters of the pattern or kit that you're editing are remembered until you turn off the power. Even if you select a different pattern or kit, and then re-select the one you had been editing, it is recalled in the edited state; however, if you turn the power off and on again, it returns to the unedited state. If you want to keep the edits that you made to a pattern or kit, you must save that pattern or kit.

[ENTER] button

Use this button mainly to confirm a value or execute an operation.

[VALUE] knob

This is used to modify values.

[KIT] button

Selects a kit.

page 14

[INST] button

Selects a sound (instrument's tone) for the instrument.

page 15

[SAMPLE] button

Selects a sample as the sound (instrument's tone) for the instrument.

page 17

[CTRL SELECT] button

Specifies the item that is controlled by each instrument's **[CTRL]** knob.

page 15

[COPY] button

Copies a pattern/kit.

page 19

[UTILITY] button

Lets you edit or initialize various settings.

page 23

TEMPO display

Shows the tempo.

[TEMPO] knob

Specifies the tempo.

page 20

[SHUFFLE] knob

Adjusts the amount of shuffle (bounce).

[MUTE] button

Mutes (silences) the selected instrument.

Inst pad

This pad plays the sound of the corresponding instrument.

You can use this to perform along with a pattern. The volume changes according to how strongly you strike an inst pad (the pad is velocity-sensitive).

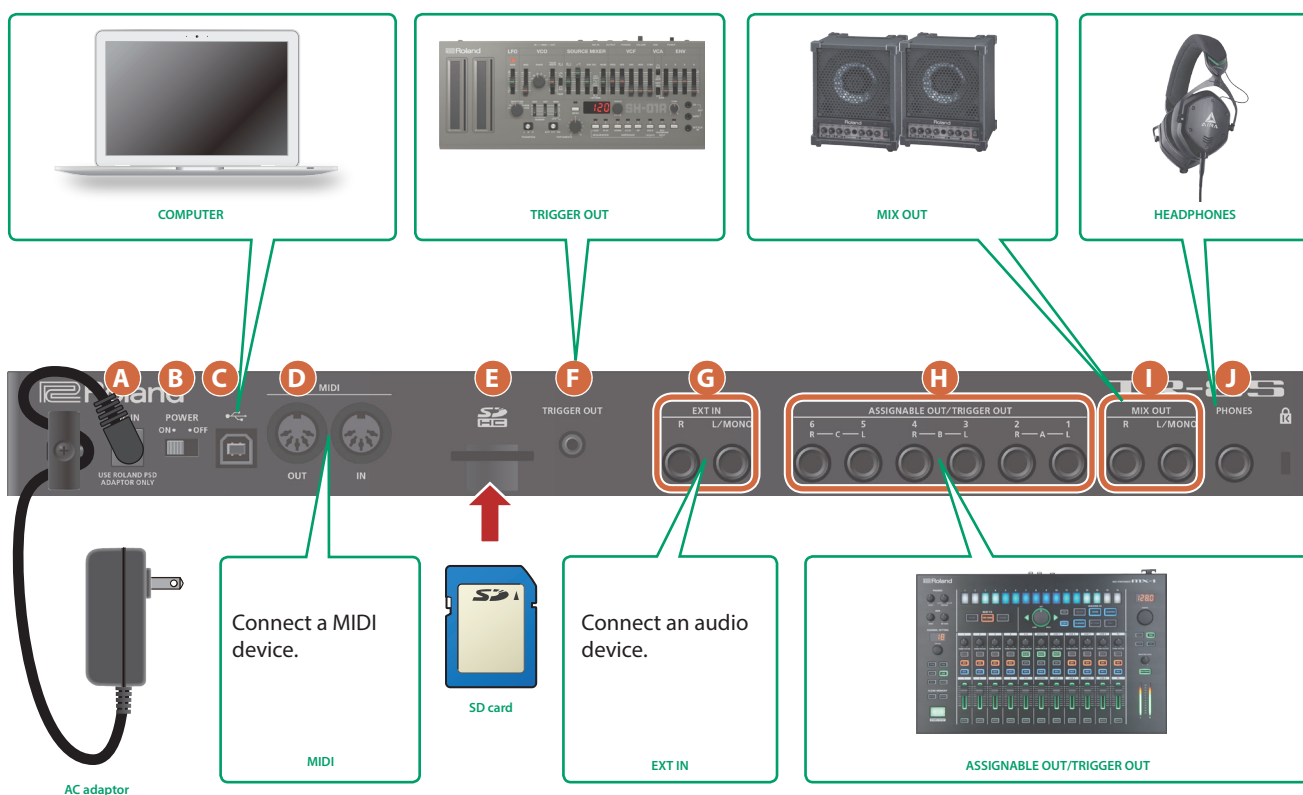
10 Pad [1]–[16]

Mode	Explanation
TR-REC	For each step, specify whether the instrument's tone will sound.
PTN SELECT	Select a pattern. Hold down the [PTN SELECT] button and use pads [1]–[8] to select a bank. Release the [PTN SELECT] button and use pads [1]–[16] to select a number.

Mode	Explanation
INST PLAY	- Pads [1]–[11](INST) play instrument's tones. - If you hold down either the [12] or [13] (ROLL) pad (or both) and press a [1]–[11] pad, the instrument's tone plays a roll. There are three types of roll (16th note, 32nd note, 64th note).
INST REC	During realtime recording, the pads record the corresponding instrument's tone.

Rear Panel (Connecting Your Equipment)

* To prevent malfunction and equipment failure, always turn down the volume, and turn off all the units before making any connections.



A DC IN jack

Connect the included AC adaptor here.

* To prevent the inadvertent disruption of power to your unit (should the plug be pulled out accidentally), and to avoid applying undue stress to the jack, anchor the power cord using the cord hook, as shown in the illustration.

B [POWER] switch

This turns the power on/off.

➔ **"Introduction"** (p. 7)

C USB port

Use a commercially available USB 2.0 cable to connect this port to your computer. It can be used to transfer USB MIDI and USB audio data. You must install the USB driver before connecting the TR-8S to your computer. Download the USB driver from the Roland website. For details, refer to Readme.htm which is included in the download.

➔ <https://www.roland.com/support/>

D MIDI (OUT, IN) jacks

Use a commercially available MIDI cable to connect MIDI devices here.

E SD card slot

Insert a commercially available SD card here.

* Never turn off the power or remove the memory card while the screen indicates **"Executing."**

* The memory card write protect feature (LOCK)
The contents of the memory card can be protected by write protecting it. To write protect a card, slide the write protect switch on the side of the memory card to the **"LOCK"** position. Unlock write protect to edit data on the card.

* All memory cards eventually wear out. We recommend that you consider the memory card not as a permanent storage site, but as a place to store data temporarily. We also recommend that you back up important data onto other media that is supported by your unit.

Write protect switch



F TRIGGER OUT jack

A trigger pulse is output from this jack at the timing that is specified in the dedicated trigger out track ([CC] + [RC] button).

G EXT IN (L/MONO, R) jacks

These are audio input jacks.

You can apply a side-chain effect at the pattern of the specified track.

➔ For details, refer to “Reference Manual” (PDF).

H ASSIGNABLE OUT/TRIGGER OUT jacks

For each jack 1–6, you can choose whether it operates as ASSIGNABLE OUT or as TRIGGER OUT.

Instruments that are output to a jack operating as ASSIGNABLE OUT are not output from the MIX OUT jacks.

Instruments that are output to a jack operating as TRIGGER OUT are also output from the MIX OUT jacks.

I MIX OUT (L/MONO, R) jacks

Connect these jacks to your amp or monitor speakers.

J PHONES jack

A set of headphones can be connected to this jack.

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Introduction

* Before turning the unit on/off, always be sure to turn the volume down. Even with the volume turned down, you might hear some sound when switching the unit on/off. However, this is normal and does not indicate a malfunction.

Turning the TR-8S On

1. Turn on the power in the order of the TR-8S first, and then the connected system.
2. Switch on power to the connected equipment, and raise the volume to an appropriate level.

Turning Off the Power

1. Power-off the connected system first, and then the TR-8S.

Formatting an SD Card (SD CARD FORMAT)

If using an SD card, please format it on the TR-8S.

SD cards are sold separately. Please obtain a SD card separately.

1. Press the [UTILITY] button.

The UTILITY screen appears.

2. Use the [VALUE] knob to select “SD CARD:Format.”

```
SD CARD:
Format >
```

3. Press the [ENTER] button.

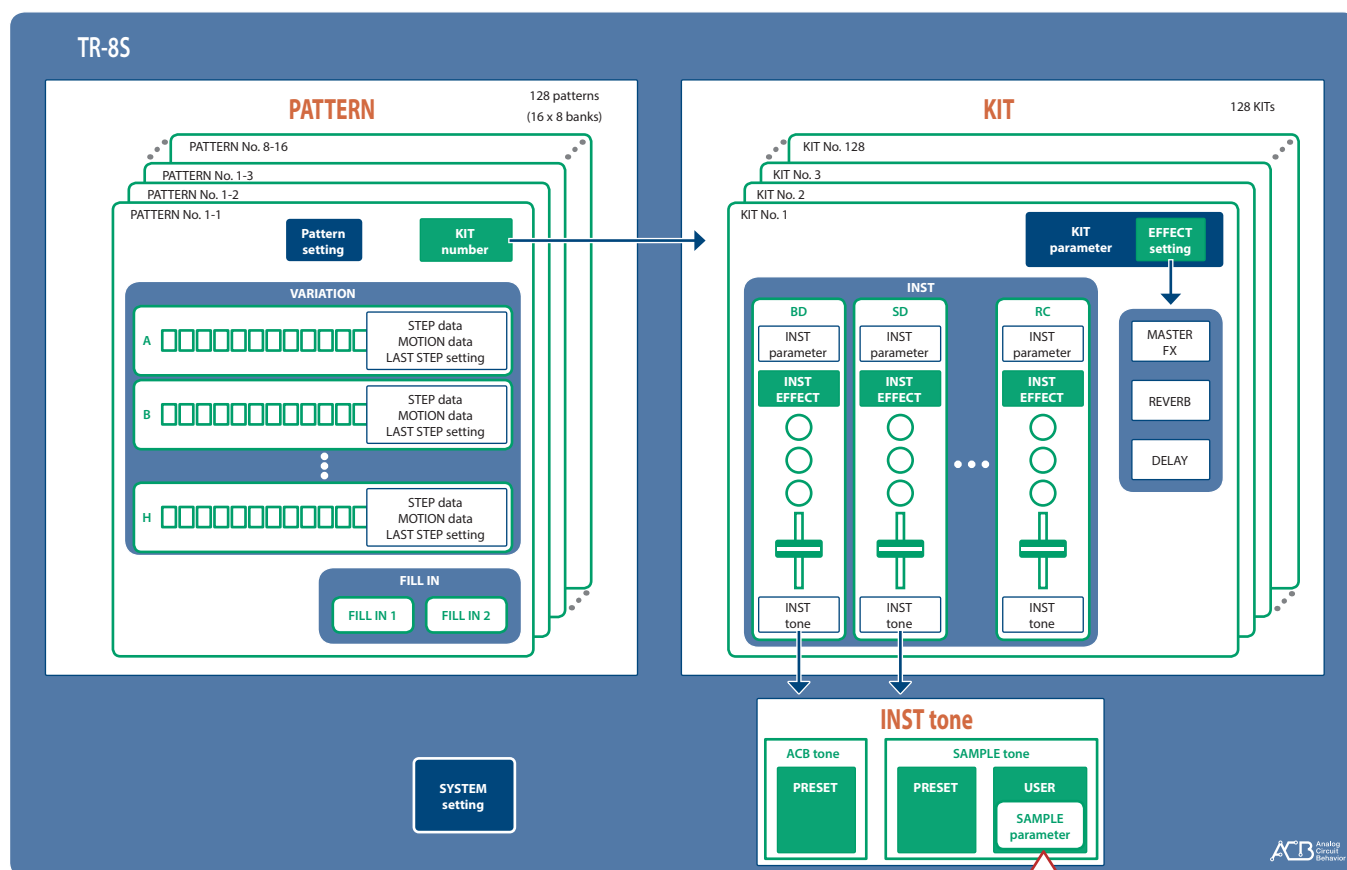
A confirmation message appears.

```
Format SD Card?
[Cancel] [OK]
```

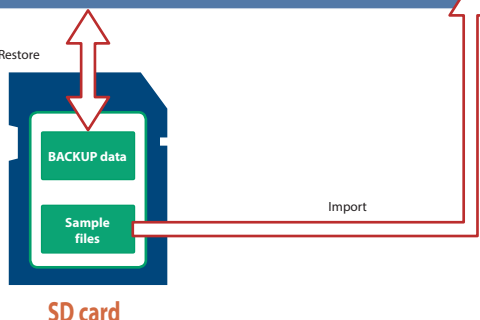
4. To execute, use the [VALUE] knob to select “OK,” and press the [ENTER] button.

If you decide to cancel, use the [VALUE] knob to select “Cancel,” and then press the [ENTER] button.

Overview of the TR-8S



* If you want to make a backup, save the data (patterns, kits, system settings) before you proceed. The backup will not include the pattern or kit that you're currently editing (shown by an "X" indication) or system settings that you have not saved.

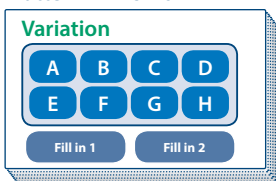


What Is a "PATTERN"?

The performance data that you record using TR-REC or INST-REC is called a **"pattern."**

The TR-8S has 128 patterns (16 patterns x 8 banks); each pattern has eight variations (A–H) and two fill-in patterns.

Pattern 1-1–8-16

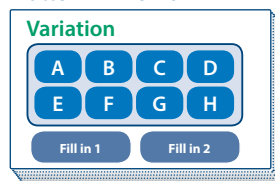


What Is a "KIT"?

The 11 instruments are collectively called a **"kit."** The TR-8S has 128 kits.

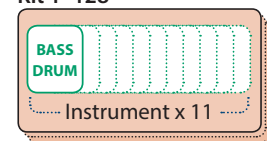
The pattern plays the instruments of the currently selected kit.

Pattern 1-1–8-16



A pattern plays the inst of the kit.

Kit 1-128



About saving the pattern and kit

Parameters of the pattern or kit that you're editing are remembered until you turn off the power. Even if you select a different pattern or kit, and then re-select the one you had been editing, it is recalled in the edited state; however, if you turn the power off and on again, it returns to the unedited state. **If you want to keep the edits that you made to a pattern or kit, you must save that pattern or kit.**

Saving the pattern and kit simultaneously (OVERWRITE)

By holding down the **[SHIFT]** button and pressing the **[WRITE]** button, you can overwrite-save the selected pattern and kit.

For details on how to save other settings, refer to **"Saving the Pattern, Kit, or System Settings (WRITE)"** (p. 18).

Playing Patterns

Playing Patterns

1. Press the **[START/STOP]** button.
2. Use the controllers of the instrument edit section to modify the sound.

MEMO

To return to the beginning of the pattern, hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press the **[START/STOP]** button.

Selecting a Pattern

1. Hold down the **[PTN SELECT]** button and press a pad **[1]–[8]**.

The bank is selected.

2. Release the **[PTN SELECT]** button.

3. Use pads **[1]–[16]** to select a pattern.

The selected pad blinks. During playback, it is lit.

When you select the next pattern during playback, the pad blinks. The pattern switches when playback returns to the first step.

You can select a region by pressing two pads simultaneously. The selected patterns play in succession.

4. Use the **[A]–[H]** buttons to select a variation.

You can select multiple instruments by holding down a button and pressing other buttons.

The selected variations are lit, and those whose buttons are lit play once each in the order of A → H.

Changing the Length of the Variation

(Setting the Variation's Last Step)

The overall number of steps used by a variation (the variation's last step) can be specified individually for each variation.

1. Press the **[LAST]** button.
2. Use the **[A]–[H]** buttons to select the variation that you want to change.
 - * You can select multiple variations by holding down a button and pressing other buttons.
3. Use pads **[1]–[16]** to select the last step.

Changing the Length of a Specific Track

(Setting the Track's Last Step)

1. Press the **[LAST]** button.
2. Use the instrument select buttons **[BD]–[RC]** to select the track that you want to change.
 - * You can select multiple instruments by holding down a button and pressing other buttons.
3. Use pads **[1]–[16]** to select the last step.

Clearing a track's Last Step setting

1. Press the **[LAST]** button.

The **[LAST]** button is lit.
2. Press the instrument select button **[BD]–[RC]** of the track whose setting you want to clear.

The instrument select button that you pressed blinks.
The currently-specified last step is shown by pads **[1]–[16]**.
3. Press the **[CLEAR]** button.

The last step of the selected track is cleared, and pads **[1]–[16]** go dark; the last step is set to the overall number of steps specified for each variation.

About variations

Each pattern has eight variations, A–H.

Press an **[A]–[H]** button to select the variation A–H that you want to play back or record.

If you want to play back multiple variations, hold down one of the **[A]–[H]** buttons and press the other **[A]–[H]** buttons that you want to additionally play back.

Lit/unlit state of the variation **[A]–[H]** buttons

Lit green	Ready to play
Blinking green	Playing
Blinking red	During PLAY&REC (TR-REC/INST REC)
Short blinking red	Selected for both PLAY and REC (TR-REC only)
Short blinking orange	Not selected for PLAY but selected for REC (TR-REC only)

Selecting the variation during TR-REC

While **[TR-REC]** is lit, pressing an **[A]–[H]** button makes the **[A]–[H]** button blink red or briefly blink red, allowing you to select a single variation A–H for TR-REC.

During TR-REC, you can hold down the **[TR-REC]** button and press an **[A]–[H]** button to select the recording target while maintaining the variation(s) that you selected for playback. (You can also select a variation that's not being played back.)

About fill-in

Each pattern has two dedicated FILL IN variations. You can also use the Scatter function as a fill-in.

➔ **"Selecting a Fill-In Variation"** (p. 10)

What Is Scatter?

"Scatter" adds a digital-feeling groove to the loop playback by exchanging individual steps within the loop playback and also by changing the playback direction or gate length.

* The scatter effect will not apply to the first cycle of the loop; the effect will apply to the second and subsequent cycles of the loop.

Generating a Random Pattern

You can automatically generate a random pattern. This modifies the selected pattern.

1. Hold down the **[PTN SELECT]** button and press the **[SAMPLE]** button.

A random pattern is provisionally generated for the variation.

The **[TR-REC]** button blinks.

2. When you press the **[TR-REC]** button, the provisionally generated random pattern changes to the current pattern.

In this state, the pattern is not yet saved. If you want to save it, execute the WRITE operation.

→ “Saving the Pattern, Kit, or System Settings (WRITE)” (p. 18)

Copying a Pattern

1. Press the **[COPY]** button.

The COPY screen appears.



2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “Pattern,” and then press the **[ENTER]** button.
3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the copy-source, and press the **[ENTER]** button.



4. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the copy-destination, and press the **[ENTER]** button.

A confirmation message appears.

5. To copy, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “OK,” and press the **[ENTER]** button.

If you decide to cancel, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “Cancel,” and then press the **[ENTER]** button.

Deleting a Pattern

1. Press the **[PTN SELECT]** button.
2. Hold down the **[CLEAR]** button and use the pads **[1]–[16]** to specify the pattern that you want to delete.

Copying a Variation

1. Press the **[COPY]** button.

The COPY screen appears.



2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “Variation,” and then press the **[ENTER]** button.
3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob and the **[ENTER]** button to select the copy-source.

Pattern number



Variation

4. Use the **[VALUE]** knob and the **[ENTER]** button to select the copy-destination.

A confirmation message appears.

5. To copy, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “OK,” and press the **[ENTER]** button.

If you decide to cancel, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “Cancel,” and then press the **[ENTER]** button.

Selecting a Fill-In Variation

1. While holding down the **AUTO FILL IN [ON]** button, press a pad **[14]–[16]** or an **[A]–[H]** button.

You can also use a variation A–H as a FILL IN.

Pads **[14]–[16]** and the **[A]–[H]** buttons blink. (The selected button is lit.)

MEMO

If FILL IN Type = SCATTER, you can hold down the **AUTO FILL IN [MANUAL TRIG]** button and use the **[VALUE]** knob to control SCATTER DEPTH.

Inserting a Fill-In (Manual Trigger)

1. At the moment that you want to insert a fill-in, press the **AUTO FILL IN [MANUAL TRIG]** button.

Inserting a Fill-In at Regular Intervals (Auto Fill In)

Here's how to automatically insert a fill-in at intervals of the specified number of measures.

1. Turn the **AUTO FILL IN [AUTO FILL IN]** knob.

Value: 32, 16, 12, 8, 4, 2

2. Press the **AUTO FILL IN [ON]** button.

A fill-in is automatically inserted at intervals of the specified number of measures.

Adjusting the Reverb or Delay

Here's how to adjust the reverb or delay.

Target	Controller
Volume of the reverb sound	REVERB [LEVEL] knob
Reverb length	[KIT] button + REVERB [LEVEL] knob
Volume of the delay sound	DELAY [LEVEL] knob
Delay time	DELAY [TIME] knob
Delay feedback	DELAY [FEEDBACK] knob

For detailed reverb and delay settings, refer to “Editing a Kit's Settings (KIT Edit)” (p. 14).

Master Effect

1. Press the **MASTER FX [ON]** button to make it light.
2. Use the **MASTER FX [CTRL]** knob to adjust the depth of the effect.

→ “Master Effect (MASTER FX)” (p. 15)

TR-REC (Step Recording)

In this method of recording, you create a pattern by specifying the steps at which each track will sound. You can even play back the pattern while you're creating it.

* If you want to keep the edits that you made to a pattern or kit, you must save that pattern or kit (p. 18).

1. Press the **[TR-REC]** button.
2. Use the variation buttons to select A–H.
3. Press the **[START/STOP]** button to start recording.
4. Press one of the **INST** select buttons to select the track that you want to record.
5. Press pads **[1]–[16]** to input the steps at which you want sound to play.
6. Repeat steps 4–5.

MEMO

You can change the scale. For details, refer to “Editing the Pattern Settings (Pattern Setting)” (p. 13).

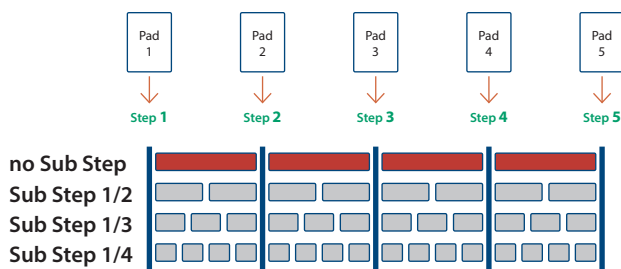
Inputting Sub Steps

You can sub-divide a step and input sub steps within it.

1. Press the **[SUB]** button.
2. Press a pad **[1]–[16]**.

By holding down the **[SUB]** button and turning the **[VALUE]** knob you can choose 1/2, 1/3, or 1/4 as the number of step divisions.

Sub Step



MEMO

You can also input a sub step by holding down the **[SUB]** button and pressing a pad **[1]–[16]**.

Specifying a Flam

1. Hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press the **[SUB]** button to set SUB STEP to FLAM.

SUB STEP and FLAM alternate each time you press the button.

2. Press a pad **[1]–[16]**.

Inputting Weak Beats

1. While holding down the **[SHIFT]** button, press a pad **[1]–[16]**.

Inputting Alternate Sounds (ALT INST)

For sounds whose name includes a “/” character, such as 707Bass1/2, you can input alternate sounds.

1. While holding down an instrument select button **[BD]–[RC]**, press a pad **[1]–[16]**.

Alternate sounds

Although one sound is assigned to each pad, sounds (instrument's tones) whose name includes a “/” character, such as 707Bass1/2, are also assigned a second sound (alternate sound).

You can switch between normal sounds and alternate sounds for performance.

Specifying Accents

1. Press the **ACCENT [STEP]** button.
2. Press pads **[1]–[16]** to select the steps at which you want to add an accent.
3. Use the **ACCENT [LEVEL]** knob to adjust the volume of the accent.

Deleting a Recorded Step from the Track

Deleting only a portion

If you press the **[CLEAR]** button during playback, the step of the track selected by the **INST** select buttons is deleted from the pattern only while you're holding down the **[CLEAR]** button.

Deleting all

While holding down the track select button of the instrument that you want to delete, press the **[CLEAR]** button.

Recording/Playing MOTION

While the **MOTION [REC]** button is lit, movements of the instrument **[TUNE]** knobs, **[DECAY]** knobs, and **[CTRL]** knobs are recorded in the steps.

While the **MOTION [ON]** button is lit, recorded movements of the instrument **[TUNE]**, **[DECAY]**, and **[CTRL]** knobs are played back.

* REVERB LEVEL, DELAY LEVEL/TIME/FEEDBACK, MASTER FX CTRL, and MASTER FX ON are also recorded and played back according to the state of the buttons described above.

Another operating method

1. While a pattern plays, hold down the **MOTION [REC]** button and operate a knob.

This lets you record a motion only while you're holding down the button.

Entering a value at a specified step

While the **[TR-REC]** button is lit, you can specify a step and enter a value for a knob.

1. Operate a knob while holding down a pad **[1]–[16]**.

INST-REC (Realtime Recording)

In this method of recording, you create a pattern by realtime-recording your performance on pads [1] (BD)–[11] (RC). This modifies the selected pattern.

* If you want to keep the edits that you made to a pattern or kit, you must save that pattern or kit (p. 18).

1. Press the **[INST REC]** button.
2. Press the **[START/STOP]** button to start recording.
3. Use the variation buttons **[A]–[H]** to select the variation that you want to record.
4. Perform using pads **[1] (BD)–[11] (RC)**.

* Operations in the instrument edit section are not recorded.

Playing Sub Steps

Here's how to play or record sub steps.

1. Press the **[SUB]** button.
2. Press the pad **[1]–[16]** that will play sub steps.

MEMO

By holding down the **[SUB]** button and turning the **[VALUE]** knob you can choose from 1/2, 1/3, or 1/4 as the number of step divisions.

You can also play a sub step by holding down the **[SUB]** button and pressing a pad **[1]–[16]**.

Specifying a Flam

Here's how to play or record a flam on the instrument's tone.

1. Hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press the **[SUB]** button to set SUB STEP to FLAM.

SUB STEP and FLAM alternate each time you press the button.

2. Press a pad **[1] (BD)–[11] (RC)**.

This lets you play or record a flam on the instrument's tone.

Playing Weak Beats

1. While holding down the **[SHIFT]** button, press a pad **[1] (BD)–[11] (RC)**.

This lets you play or record weak beats.

Playing Alternate Sounds

For sounds whose name includes a "/" character, such as 707Bass1/2, you can play or record alternate sounds.

1. While holding down an instrument select button **[BD]–[RC]**, press a pad **[1] (BD)–[11] (RC)**.

Deleting a Recorded Step from the Track

Deleting only a portion

If you press the **[CLEAR]** button during playback, the step of the track selected by the instrument select button is deleted from the pattern only while you're holding down the **[CLEAR]** button.

Deleting all

While holding down the instrument select button of the track that you want to delete, press the **[CLEAR]** button.

Recording/Playing MOTION

While the MOTION **[REC]** button is lit, movements of the instrument **[TUNE]** knobs, **[DECAY]** knobs, and **[CTRL]** knobs are recorded in the steps.

While the MOTION **[ON]** button is lit, recorded movements of the instrument **[TUNE]**, **[DECAY]**, and **[CTRL]** knobs are played back.

* REVERB LEVEL, DELAY LEVEL/TIME/FEEDBACK, MASTER FX CTRL, and MASTER FX ON are also recorded and played back according to the state of the buttons described above.

Another operating method

1. Operate a knob while holding down the MOTION **[REC]** button.

This lets you record a motion only while you're holding down the button.

Using the Inst Pad

You can use the instrument select buttons to play or record the selected instrument.

The volume changes depending on the strength at which you strike the inst pad.

Using the Inst Pad to Play Instruments

During INST PLAY / During PATTERN SELECT

1. Use the instrument select buttons to select the instrument that you want to play from the inst pad.
2. Press the inst pad to play the instrument that you selected in step 1.

Recording While You Use the Inst Pad to Play Instruments

During TR-REC / During INST REC

1. Press the **[TR-REC]** button or the **[INST REC]** button.
2. Press the **[START/STOP]** button, and start recording.
3. Use the instrument select buttons to select the instrument that you want to play from the inst pad.
4. Press the inst pad to record the instrument that you selected in step 3.

INST-PLAY (Performing)

You can use pads [1] (BD)–[11] (RC) to perform in real time.

Your performance does not modify the pattern.

1. Press the **[INST PLAY]** button.
2. Perform using pads [1] (BD)–[11] (RC).

Playing Sub Steps

Here's how to play sub steps.

This lets you play duplets, triplets, and quadruplets.

1. Press the **[SUB]** button.
2. Press the pad [1]–[16] that will play sub steps.

MEMO

By holding down the **[SUB]** button and turning the **[VALUE]** knob you can choose from 1/2, 1/3, or 1/4 as the number of step divisions.

You can also play a sub step by holding down the **[SUB]** button and pressing a pad [1]–[16].

Performing a Flam

Here's how to perform a flam on an instrument's tone.

1. Hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press the **[SUB]** button to set SUB STEP to FLAM.
2. Press a pad [1] (BD)–[11] (RC).

This lets you perform a flam on the instrument's tone.

Performing Weak Beats (WEAK BEATS)

1. While holding down the **[SHIFT]** button, press a pad [1] (BD)–[11] (RC).

This lets you perform weak beats.

Performing Alternate Sounds (ALT INST)

For sounds whose name includes a "/" character, such as 707Bass1/2, you can perform alternate sounds.

1. While holding down an instrument select button **[BD]–[RC]**, press a pad [1] (BD)–[11] (RC).

Performing a Roll (ROLL)

Here's how to perform a roll on an instrument's tone.

1. While holding down a pad [12]–[13], press a pad [1]–[11].

This lets you perform a roll on the instrument's tone.

Alternate method

1. While holding down the **[INST PLAY]** button, press a pad [12]–[13].

Pad [12]–[13] is lit.

2. Press a pad [1]–[11].

This lets you perform a roll on the instrument's tone.

3. To stop playing the roll, press the pad [12]–[13] once again.

Roll speed

Pad	Explanation
Pad [12]	Sixteenth note
Pad [13]	Thirty-second note
Pad [12] + [13]	Sixty-fourth note

Editing the Pattern Settings (Pattern Setting)

Here's how to specify the kit and tempo that are used by a pattern.

1. Hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press the **[PTN SELECT]** button.

The PTN SETTING screen appears.



2. Select a parameter.

2-1. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select a parameter.

2-2. Press the **[ENTER]** button.

3. Modify values.

3-1. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to edit the parameter value.

3-2. Press the **[ENTER]** button.

Return to the parameter selection (step 2).

4. Press the **[PTN SELECT]** button.

You exit the PTN SETTING screen.

PTN SETTING parameter

Parameter	Explanation
KIT:SW	Turn this on if you want to use the kit that's selected by the "KIT:Number" parameter.
KIT:Number	Selects the kit used by the pattern.
Tempo	Specifies the tempo of the pattern.
Scale	Selects the scale.
Shuffle	Specifies the amount of shuffle (bounce).
Flam Spacing	Specifies the flam spacing.
ScatterType	Selects the type of scatter.
ScatterDepth	Adjusts the depth of scatter.
NAME	Specifies the name of the pattern.

➔ For details, refer to "Reference Manual" (PDF).

Editing a Kit or Instrument

Selecting Kits (KIT)

Here's how to select kits.

1. Press the [KIT] button to make it light.

The KIT screen appears.



If the kit is being edited, an "*" is shown at the left side of the kit number.

2. Use the [VALUE] knob to select a kit.

3. Press the [KIT] button once again.

Exit the KIT screen.

Editing a Kit's Settings (KIT Edit)

Here's how to edit the settings of the currently selected kit.

* If you want to keep the edited kit settings, you must save the kit (p. 18).

1. Hold down the [SHIFT] button and press the [KIT] button.

The KIT Edit screen appears.



2. Select a parameter.

2-1. Use the [VALUE] knob to select a parameter.

2-2. Press the [ENTER] button.

Proceed to editing the parameter value (step 3).

3. Modify values.

3-1. Use the [VALUE] knob to edit the parameter value.

3-2. Press the [ENTER] button.

Return to selecting a parameter (step 2).

4. Press the [KIT] button.

Exit the KIT Edit screen.

KIT Edit parameter

Category	Explanation
LEVEL	Level parameter
REVERB	Edit the reverb settings. ➔ "Detailed Reverb Settings" (p. 14)
DELAY	Edit the delay settings. ➔ "Detailed Delay Settings" (p. 14)
MASTER FX	➔ "Master Effect (MASTER FX)" (p. 15)
EXT IN	➔ "Inputting an External Audio Source (EXT IN)" (p. 21)
LFO	➔ "Using the LFO to Modify a Parameter" (p. 16)
OUTPUT	Specifies the output destination of each instrument. MIX, ASSIGN 1–6 (mono), ASSIGN A–C (stereo)
MUTE	Specifies the mute setting of each instrument. Muting occurs when the specified instrument is sounded.
CTRL	Assigns a parameter to the [CTRL] knobs of the instrument edit section. ➔ "Assigning a Different Function for Each Instrument to the [CTRL] Knob" (p. 15)

Category	Explanation
COLOR	Specifies the color of the level fader LEDs.
NAME	Rename the kit. ➔ "Entering a Kit Name or Other Characters" (p. 18)

➔ For details, refer to "Reference Manual" (PDF).

MEMO

- When you switch kits, the position of the knobs might differ from the values of the kit; for such cases, you can choose whether knob movement changes the sound immediately or only after the knob position matches or passes through the value of the kit.
➔ "UTILITY" → "GENERAL" → "KnobMode" parameter
- The parameters of the kit that you are editing are remembered until you turn off the power. If you select a different kit and then re-select the edited kit, it comes back in the edited state; however, if you turn the power off and on again, the kit returns to its state prior to editing. If you want to keep the edited kit settings, you must save the kit.
➔ "Saving the Pattern, Kit, or System Settings (WRITE)" (p. 18)

Detailed Reverb Settings

In the KIT Edit screen, select REVERB.

Parameter	Explanation
Type	Type of reverb
Time	Time length of reverberation * You can control this by holding down the [KIT] button and turning the REVERB [LEVEL] knob.
Level	Output level of reverberation * You can use the REVERB [LEVEL] knob to control this.
Pre Delay	Adjusts the delay time from the direct sound until the reverb sound is heard.
Low Cut	Adjusts the frequency below which the low-frequency content of the reverb will be reduced.
High Cut	Adjusts the frequency above which the high-frequency content of the reverb will be reduced.
Density	Density of reverb

Detailed Delay Settings

In the KIT Edit screen, select DELAY.

Parameter	Explanation
Type	Type of delay
TempoSync	Synchronizes the delay time (Time) to the tempo.
Level	Output level of delay sound * You can use the DELAY [LEVEL] knob to control this.
Time	Adjusts the delay time from the direct sound until the delay sound is heard. * You can use the DELAY [TIME] knob to control this.
Feedback	Adjusts the amount of delay feedback. * You can use the DELAY [FEEDBACK] knob to control this.

The editable parameters differ depending on the type of delay.

➔ For details, refer to "Reference Manual" (PDF).

Master Effect (MASTER FX)

Here's how to apply the master effect to the kit.

1. Hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press the **MASTER FX [ON]** button.

The KIT EDIT screen's MASTER EFX items are shown.

KIT:MASTER FX
Type HPF

2. Select a master effect type.

The editable parameters differ for each effect.

➔ For details, refer to “**Reference Manual**” (PDF).

MEMO

You can use the MASTER FX **[CTRL]** knob to edit the assigned parameter.

3. Press the **[KIT]** button.

Exit the screen.

Assigning Parameters to the [CTRL] Knobs (CTRL SELECT)

You can assign parameters to the **[CTRL]** knobs of the instrument edit section, and control those parameters while the pattern plays back.

1. Press the **[CTRL SELECT]** button to make it light.

The CTRL SELECT screen appears.

CTRL SELECT:
User

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select a parameter.

The same parameter is selected for all **[CTRL]** knobs.

3. Press the **[CTRL SELECT]** button once again.

The **[CTRL SELECT]** button goes dark, and you exit the CTRL SELECT screen.

Assigning a Different Function for Each Instrument to the [CTRL] Knob

1. While holding down the **[CTRL SELECT]** button, press a **[BD]–[RC]** button.

The parameter that's assigned to the **[CTRL]** knob is displayed.

KIT CTRL:BD
Attack

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select a parameter.

3. Press the **[CTRL SELECT]** button.

The **[CTRL SELECT]** button goes dark, and you exit the screen.

MEMO

You can also select from the assignable parameters by holding down the **[CTRL SELECT]** button and directly operating the **[CTRL]** knob.

- The assignment that you make is saved in the “**User**” parameter which you can select in step 2 of “**Assigning Parameters to the [CTRL] Knobs (CTRL SELECT)**” (p. 15).

Playing Multiple Instruments Layered

(GROUPING for Layer)

You can create a group of multiple instruments and play their layered sound with a single note.

You can use grouped master instruments in the following ways. The slave instrument follows the master instrument.

- Pattern input in “**TR-REC**”
- Pad performance in “**INST PLAY**”
- Pad recording in “**INST REC**”

Grouping Instruments

1. In the KIT Edit screen, long-press the **[BD]–[RC]** button that you want to specify as the master instrument.

The INST GROUP screen appears.

INST GROUP: BD
M-----

2. While holding down the button that you pressed in step 1, press the **[BD]–[RC]** button that you want to specify as the slave instrument.

The instruments that you selected as the master instrument and the slave instrument are grouped.

MEMO

- During TR-REC, when you press a grouped **[BD]–[RC]** button, the **[BD]–[RC]** button of the master instrument () lights and the **[BD]–[RC]** button of the slave instrument () blinks.
- During INST PLAY/INST REC, pressing a pad **[1]–[11]** of a grouped slave instrument does not produce sound.
- If you press the **[MUTE]** button, the same group's master instrument's **[BD]–[RC]** button lights and the slave instrument's **[BD]–[RC]** button blinks.

Selecting an Instrument's Tone (INST)

Instrument's tones of the currently selected kit are selected individually.

1. Press the **[INST]** button.

The **[INST]** button and the **[BD]–[RC]** button (that had been selected for **[TR-REC]**) are lit, and [the INST screen appears.

INST: BD
909Bass1

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the instrument's tone.

MEMO

To switch categories, hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and turn the **[VALUE]** knob.

3. Press the **[INST]** button once again.

Exit the INST screen.

Editing an Instrument's Sound (INST Edit)

1. Hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press the **[INST]** button.

The INST Edit screen appears.

INST:BD
Tune 0

2. Select a parameter.
 - 2-1. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select a parameter.
 - 2-2. Press the **[ENTER]** button.
3. Modify values.
 - 3-1. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to edit the parameter value.
 - 3-2. Press the **[ENTER]** button.

Return to the parameter selection (step 2).
4. Press the **[INST]** button.

Exit the INST Edit screen.

➔ For details, refer to “**Reference Manual**” (PDF).

Changing an Instrument's Pan

1. In the INST Edit screen, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the “**Pan**” parameter.

INST:BD
Pan CENTER

2. Press the **[ENTER]** button.
3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to edit the parameter value.
4. Press the **[ENTER]** button.
5. Press the lit **[INST]** button.

Value: L127-CENTER-R127

Exit the INST Edit screen.

Changing an Instrument's Gain

1. In the INST Edit screen, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the “**Gain**” parameter.

INST:BD
Gain 0.0dB

2. Press the **[ENTER]** button.
3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to edit the parameter value.
4. Press the **[ENTER]** button.
5. Press the lit **[INST]** button.

Value: -INF, -40.0dB-0.0dB-+40.0dB

Exit the INST Edit screen.

Copying a Kit (KIT COPY)

1. Hold down the **[COPY]** button and press the **[KIT]** button.

The KIT COPY screen appears.

KIT COPY: Src
001 001

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the copy-source, and press the **[ENTER]** button.
 3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the copy-destination, and press the **[ENTER]** button.
- A confirmation message appears.
4. To copy, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “**OK**,” and press the **[ENTER]** button.
- If you decide to cancel, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “**Cancel**,” and then press the **[ENTER]** button.

Using the LFO to Modify a Parameter

You can select a parameter that you want to modify, and use the LFO to modify the parameter value.

1. In the INST Edit screen, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “**LFO**,” and press the **[ENTER]** button.
2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the parameter that you want to modify, and press the **[ENTER]** button.
3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select “**LFO Depth**,” and then press the **[ENTER]** button.
4. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to specify the depth of change.
5. Press the **[ENTER]** button.
6. Press the lit **[INST]** button.

Value: -128-0-+127

Exit the INST Edit screen.

MEMO

In the KIT Edit screen you can edit the LFO waveform (Waveform), frequency (Rate), and tempo synchronization (TempoSync).

LFO

KIT parameter

(Settings for the entire kit)

LFO Waveform
LFO Rate
LFO Tempo Sync

INST parameter

(Settings for each instrument)

LFO (Parameter to apply)
LFO Depth

Assigning an Imported User Sample to an Instrument

Importing a User Sample (SAMPLE Import)

Here's how an audio file saved on an SD card can be imported as a user sample.

- * Use the TR-8S to format the SD card.
- * The maximum length of a single audio file that can be imported is approximately 180 seconds (in the case of 44.1 kHz/MONO). Depending on the state of memory usage, the maximum time might be shorter.

1. Using your computer, copy an audio file to the following folder of the SD card.

ROLAND\TR-8S\SAMPLE\

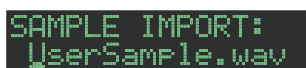
File formats that can be imported

WAV, AIFF

2. Insert the SD card into the TR-8S (p. 6).

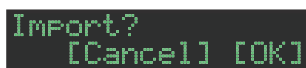
3. Press the [UTILITY] button.

4. Use the [VALUE] knob to select "Sample Import," and then press the [ENTER] button.



5. Use the [VALUE] knob to select the audio file that you want to import, and press the [ENTER] button.

A confirmation message appears.



6. To execute, use the [VALUE] knob to select "OK," and press the [ENTER] button.

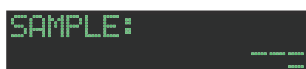
If you decide to cancel, use the [VALUE] knob to select "Cancel," and then press the [ENTER] button.

When the import is completed, the display indicates "Completed!" and you exit the UTILITY screen.

Selecting a User Sample (SAMPLE)

1. Press the [SAMPLE] button.

The [SAMPLE] button and the [BD]–[RC] button (that had been selected in [TR-REC]) are lit, and the SAMPLE screen appears.



2. Use the [VALUE] knob to select the user sample that you want to assign as the instrument's tone.



MEMO

- Choose from the sample that you imported from the SD card.
- You can press a [BD]–[RC] button to change the loading-destination.

3. Press the lit [SAMPLE] button.

The [SAMPLE] button goes dark, and you exit the SAMPLE screen.

Editing a User Sample's Settings (SAMPLE Edit)

1. Hold down the [SHIFT] button and press the [SAMPLE] button.

The SAMPLE Edit screen appears.



2. Select a parameter.

2-1. Use the [VALUE] knob to select a parameter.

2-2. Press the [ENTER] button.

3. Modify values.

3-1. Use the [VALUE] knob to edit the parameter value.

3-2. Press the [ENTER] button.

Return to the parameter selection (step 2).

NOTE

If the screen indicates "---," editing is not possible.

4. Press the lit [SAMPLE] button.

The [SAMPLE] button goes dark, and you exit the SAMPLE Edit screen.

If you had edited the settings, a screen asks whether you want to save the sample.

MEMO

- The settings you specify here are common to all kits that use the same user sample.
- ACB tone or preset samples (samples for which the  icon is shown) show the parameter values as "---"; these values cannot be edited.

Various Operations

Jumping to the Beginning of a Parameter Group

In each of the edit screens, you can jump to the beginning of a parameter group (category).

1. When selecting a parameter, hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and turn the **[VALUE]** knob.

Entering a Kit Name or Other Characters

Here's how to enter characters such as when naming a kit or pattern.

1. Access the KIT EDIT screen (p. 14) or the PTN SETTING screen (p. 13).

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select "NAME."

In the case of the KIT Edit screen

```
0KIT:NAME
Kit_001_____
```

3. Press the **[ENTER]** button to access the character input screen.

In the case of the KIT Edit screen

```
0KIT NAME:
Kit_001_____
```

4. Use the **[COPY]** (left) **[UTILITY]** (right) buttons to move the cursor.



Button	Explanation
[UTILITY] button	Moves to the right.
[COPY] button	Moves to the left.

5. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to change the character.

Button	Explanation
[SHIFT] button + [COPY] button	Deletes one character (Erase).
[SHIFT] button + [UTILITY] button	Inserts one character (Insert).
[SHIFT] button + [VALUE] knob	Switches between uppercase/ lowercase/numerals.

6. When you've finished inputting characters, press the **[ENTER]** button.

You return to the screen of step 2; the name that you input is shown.

Saving the Pattern, Kit, or System Settings (WRITE)

Here's how to save a pattern or kit.

1. Press the **[WRITE]** button.

The WRITE screen appears.

```
<WRITE>
Pattern
```

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select what you want to save, and press the **[ENTER]** button.

The WRITE screens appear in the order of "Pattern" → "Kit" → "System."

* If "System" is selected, a confirmation screen appears. Proceed to step 4.

3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the save-destination, and press the **[ENTER]** button.

A confirmation message appears.

```
Pattern Write?
[Cancel] [OK]
```

4. To save, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select "OK," and press the **[ENTER]** button.

If you decide to cancel, use the **[VALUE]** knob to select "Cancel," and then press the **[ENTER]** button.

Shortcuts for save operations

Function	Operating the Unit
Save a pattern (PATTERN WRITE screen)	Hold down the [WRITE] button and press the [PTN SELECT] button.
Save a kit (KIT WRITE screen)	Hold down the [WRITE] button and press the [KIT] button.
Save the pattern and kit simultaneously (OVERWRITE)	Hold down the [SHIFT] button and press the [WRITE] button. * The selected pattern and kit are overwrite-saved.

Copying a Pattern or Kit (COPY)

Here's how to copy a pattern or kit.

1. Press the [COPY] button.

The COPY screen appears.

2. Use the [VALUE] knob to select what you want to copy, and press the [ENTER] button.

The COPY screens appear in the order of "Pattern" → "Variation" → "Track" → "Kit" → "Inst."

3. Use the [VALUE] knob to select the copy-source, and press the [ENTER] button.

4. Use the [VALUE] knob to select the copy-destination, and press the [ENTER] button.

A confirmation message appears.

5. To execute the copy, use the [VALUE] knob to select "OK," and press the [ENTER] button.

If you decide to cancel, use the [VALUE] knob to select "Cancel," and then press the [ENTER] button.

Shortcuts for copy operations

Function	Operating the Unit
Copy a pattern (PATTERN COPY screen)	Hold down the [COPY] button and press the [PTN SELECT] button.
Copy a kit (KIT COPY screen)	Hold down the [COPY] button and press the [KIT] button.
Copy an instrument (INST COPY screen)	Hold down the [COPY] button and press the [INST] button.
Copy a pattern (selected track) (track copy-destination select screen)	Hold down the [COPY] button and press a [BD]–[RC] button.
Copy a variation (selected variation) (variation copy-destination select screen)	While holding down the [COPY] button, press a variation [A]–[H] button.

Erasing a Pattern (CLEAR)

Here's how to erase a pattern.

1. While holding down an instrument select button, press the [CLEAR] button.

This lets you erase the pattern of the selected instrument.

Only the selected variation is affected.

If playing back in TR-REC or INST REC

1. During playback, press the [CLEAR] button.

The pattern of the instrument that you select by pressing its instrument select button is erased only while you hold down the button.

Erasing Motion

Erasing all MOTION

Here's how to erase all MOTION recorded in the variation that is selected for playback.

1. Hold down the MOTION [ON] button and press the [CLEAR] button.

Erasing MOTION for a specific track

Here's how to erase all MOTION recorded for a specified track in the variation that is selected for playback.

1. Hold down the MOTION [ON] button and press an instrument select button.

Erasing MOTION for only a specific knob

Here's how to erase all MOTION for a specific knob recorded in the variation that is selected for playback.

1. Hold down the MOTION [ON] button and operate the knob.

MEMO

MOTION is also erased when you perform the operation of holding down the [CLEAR] button to erase steps.

Playing Weak Beats

You can change the way in which weak beats (WEAK BEATS) are entered during TR-REC.

Use "UTILITY" → "GENERAL" → "WeakBeat" to specify this.

Parameter	Explanation
wSHIFT	While holding down the [SHIFT] button, press a pad [1]–[16].
PAD	Each time you press a pad [1]–[16], you alternate between normal sound → weak beat → off.

Specifying the Flam Spacing

You can use the LCD screen to specify the flam spacing.

➔ "Editing the Pattern Settings (Pattern Setting)" (p. 13)

* If you specify "0," there will be no flam effect.

Muting a Track (MUTE)

1. Press the **[MUTE]** button.
2. Use the instrument select buttons to turn each instrument's mute on (unlit) or off (lit).

The **[MUTE]** button works in any state: "TR-REC," "PTN SELECT," "INST REC," or "INST PLAY."

Alternate method

1. While holding down the **[MUTE]** button, press an instrument select button.

Listening to Only the Selected Instrument (SOLO)

Here's how you can "solo" a selected instrument so that only that instrument is heard.

1. While the **[MUTE]** button is lit, hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press an instrument select button.

MEMO

To instantly defeat all muting, hold down the **[MUTE]** button and press the **[CLEAR]** button.

Adjusting the Tempo

1. Turn the **[TEMPO]** knob to adjust the tempo.

By holding down the **[SHIFT]** button and turning the **[TEMPO]** knob, you can adjust the setting in steps of 0.1 units.

The tempo is shown in the TEMPO display.

Tap Tempo

Here's how to tap-input the tempo.

1. While holding down the **[SHIFT]** button, press the **[ENTER]** button three or more times.

The tempo is specified as the average timing at which you press the button.

Marking the Tempo

You can temporarily memorize the current tempo value, and recall it later.

MEMO

The marked tempo is not saved.

Marking the tempo

Here's how to mark the current tempo value.

1. Hold down the **[MUTE]** button and press the **[UTILITY]** button.

Recalling the tempo

Here's how to switch to the marked tempo value.

1. Hold down the **[MUTE]** button and press the **[COPY]** button.

Finely Adjusting the Timing of Notes

(Nudge Function)

The "nudge" function lets you adjust the timing of notes forward or backward.

Using the nudge function changes the playback timing of the entire pattern.

Operation	Explanation
[SHIFT] + [COPY] button	Moves the playback timing forward.
[SHIFT] + [UTILITY] button	Moves the playback timing backward.

MEMO

A system setting lets you choose whether the timing of the MIDI clock will be modified.

➔ "MIDI TX: Tx Nudge"

Synchronizing/Recording with Other Devices

The TR-8S can receive MIDI Clock (F8) data to synchronize its tempo. It can also receive MIDI Start (FA) and MIDI Stop (FC) to start/stop itself.

Synchronizing with a TB-3

You can synchronize the TR-8 with a TB-3 by using a commercially available MIDI cable to make connections.



TR-8S

TB-3

Using the TR-8S as a MIDI Controller

You can use the TR-8S as a controller for your computer software without using the sounds of the TR-8S's internal sound engine.

1. Press the **[UTILITY]** button.

The setting screen appears.

```
GENERAL:
▶LCD Contrast 5
```

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select **"SOUND: Local Sw,"** and press the **[ENTER]** button.

```
SOUND:
LocalSw▶ 0N
```

3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select **"SURFACE,"** and then press the **[ENTER]** button.

```
SOUND:
LocalSw▶SURFACE
```

4. Press the lit **[UTILITY]** button.

The **[UTILITY]** button goes dark, and you exit the UTILITY screen.

* Even if you press pads or if MIDI is received, the TR-8S's internal sound engine does not produce sound.

Using the ASSIGNABLE OUT/TRIGGER OUT jacks as Trigger Out

Before you proceed, power-off all devices, and connect the jack that you want to use as TRIGGER out to your device that accepts a trigger input.

1. Press the **[UTILITY]** button.

The setting screen appears.

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the ASSIGN OUT 1–6 **"Mode"** parameter, and press the **[ENTER]** button.

```
ASSIGN OUT 1:
Mode▶ BOOST
```

3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select **"TRIGGER,"** and then press the **[ENTER]** button.

```
ASSIGN OUT 1:
Mode▶ TRIGGER
```

4. Press the **[UTILITY]** button.

The **[UTILITY]** button goes dark, and you exit the UTILITY screen.

Assigning an Instrument to the ASSIGNABLE OUT/TRIGGER OUT jacks

1. Hold down the **[SHIFT]** button and press the **[KIT]** button.

The setting screen appears.

2. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the KIT:OUTPUT **"BD"–"RC"** parameter, and press the **[ENTER]** button.

```
KIT:OUTPUT
BD▶ MIX
```

3. Use the **[VALUE]** knob to select the jack that you want to assign, and press the **[ENTER]** button.
4. Press the **[KIT]** button.

Exit the KIT Edit screen.

Inputting an External Audio Source (EXT IN)

Connect a mic, synthesizer, or rhythm machine etc. to the EXT IN jacks.

You can do the following things to the audio source that's input to the EXT IN jacks.

- Select the input (stereo input x 1 / mono input x 2)
- Apply a side-chain
- Apply reverb (Reverb Send)
- Apply delay (Delay Send)
- Select the output destination (MIX OUT / ASSIGNABLE OUT)
- Apply SCATTER (if FILL IN is set to SCATTER, and using MIX OUT output)
- Apply MASTER FX (if using MIX OUT output)

Connecting a Computer via USB

If you use a commercially available USB 2.0 cable to connect the TR-8S to your computer, you can synchronize the TR-8S with your DAW via USB MIDI, or record individual instruments of the TR-8S onto tracks of your DAW via USB audio.

In order to use the TR-8S, you'll need to download the driver from the following URL and install it on your computer.

For details on installation, refer to the following URL.

➔ <https://www.roland.com/support/>

NOTE

Do not connect the TR-8S to your computer before you have finished installing the driver.

If you have already connected the TR-8S, disconnect it, and then reconnect it after driver installation is completed.

Various Settings

Returning to the Factory Settings (FACTORY RESET)

Here's how to return the TR-8S to its factory-set state.

1. Press the [UTILITY] button.

The UTILITY screen appears.

2. Use the [VALUE] knob to select "UTILITY: Factory Reset."

```
UTILITY:
▶Factory Reset >
```

3. Press the [ENTER] button.

The target selection screen appears.

```
FACTORY RESET:
Target          ALL
```

Target	Explanation
ALL	Returns all settings including patterns and kits to their factory-set state.
KIT	Returns only the kit settings to their factory-set state.
PTN	Returns only the patterns to their factory-set state.

4. Use the [VALUE] knob to select the target, and press the [ENTER] button.

A confirmation message appears.

```
Factory Reset?
[Cancel] [OK]
```

5. To execute, use the [VALUE] knob to select "OK," and press the [ENTER] button.

If you decide to cancel, use the [VALUE] knob to select "Cancel," and then press the [ENTER] button.

6. When the display indicates "Completed. Turn off power," turn the TR-8S's power off and on again.

Backing Up Data to SD Card (BACKUP)

* If you want to make a backup, save the data (patterns, kits, system settings) before you proceed. The backup will not include the pattern or kit that you're currently editing (shown by an "*" indication) or system settings that you have not saved.

1. Press the [UTILITY] button.

The UTILITY screen appears.

2. Use the [VALUE] knob to select "UTILITY: Backup."

```
UTILITY:
▶Backup >
```

3. Press the [ENTER] button.

The BACKUP:NAME screen appears.

```
BACKUP:NAME
tr8s_bak .bin
```

MEMO

If a backup file already exists, the BACKUP:SELECT screen appears.

```
BACKUP:SELECT
Save As
```

To overwrite-save, select the existing backup file and press the [ENTER] button.

If you select Save As and press the [ENTER] button, the BACKUP:NAME screen appears.

4. Edit the name if necessary.

5. Press the [ENTER] button.

A confirmation message appears.

```
Backup?
[Cancel] [OK]
```

6. To execute, use the [VALUE] knob to select "OK," and press the [ENTER] button.

If you decide to cancel, use the [VALUE] knob to select "Cancel," and then press the [ENTER] button.

Restoring Data That Was Backed Up to SD Card

(RESTORE)

1. Press the [UTILITY] button.

The UTILITY screen appears.

2. Use the [VALUE] knob to select "UTILITY: Restore."

```
UTILITY:
▶Restore >
```

3. Press the [ENTER] button.

The RESTORE screen appears.

```
RESTORE:
tr8s_bak.bin
```

4. Use the [VALUE] knob to select the file that you want to restore.

5. Press the [ENTER] button.

A confirmation message appears.

```
Restore?
[Cancel] [OK]
```

6. To execute, use the [VALUE] knob to select "OK," and press the [ENTER] button.

If you decide to cancel, use the [VALUE] knob to select "Cancel," and then press the [ENTER] button.

Convenient Functions (UTILITY)

Here you can make system settings for the TR-8S unit itself, or back-up and restore data.

1. Press the [UTILITY] button.

The setting screen appears.

```
GENERAL:
▶LCD Contrast 5
```

2. Select a parameter.

2-1. Use the [VALUE] knob to select a parameter.

2-2. Press the [ENTER] button.

3. These are used to modify values.

3-1. Use the [VALUE] knob to edit the parameter value.

3-2. Press the [ENTER] button.

Return to the parameter selection (step 2).

4. Press the lit [UTILITY] button.

The [UTILITY] button goes dark, and you exit the UTILITY screen.

Utility

Category	Explanation
GENERAL	Makes overall settings for the entire TR-8S.
RELOAD	Returns the selected pattern or kit to the last-saved state.
SAMPLE	Imports or deletes samples.
LED	Adjusts the brightness of the button or slider LEDs.
SYNC/TEMPO	Makes synchronization-related settings.
MIDI	Makes MIDI-related settings.
SOUND	Specifies the local control setting.
MIX OUT	Makes settings for the MIX OUT jack output.
ASSIGN OUT 1-6	Make settings for the ASSIGNABLE OUT/ TRIGGER OUT 1-6 jack output.
EXT IN	Makes settings for the input signal from the EXT IN jack.
UTILITY	Backs-up or restores.
SD CARD	Formats an SD card.
INFORMATION	Displays the version of the system program.

➡ For details, refer to "Reference Manual" (PDF).

Error Messages

Message	Meaning	Action
SDCard NotReady!	The SD card is not inserted, or is inserted incompletely.	Turn off the unit, firmly insert the SD card, and then turn on the unit once again.
	The SD card was removed after you selected data that was on the SD card.	
	The format of the SD card is invalid.	Use the TR-8S to format the SD card (p. 7).
Read Error!	Data could not be read from the SD card.	Make sure that the SD card is correctly inserted.
	The file is damaged.	Do not use this file.
Write Error!	Data could not be written to the SD card.	Make sure that the SD card is correctly inserted.
	The format of the SD card is invalid.	Use the TR-8S to format the SD card (p. 7).
SD Card Full!	There is insufficient space on the SD card.	Delete unneeded data.
Sys Mem Damaged!	The contents of the TR-8S's save area may be damaged.	Execute the factory reset operation (p. 22). If this does not solve the problem, contact your dealer or customer support.

Message	Meaning	Action
MIDI Buff Full!	An unusually large amount of MIDI data was received, and could not be processed.	Reduce the amount of MIDI messages that are being transmitted.
MIDI Offline!	The MIDI IN connection was broken.	Check that there is no problem with the MIDI cable connected to the TR-8S's MIDI IN, and that the MIDI cable was not disconnected.
Program Error!	The TR-8S was unable to start up. The program could not be read correctly. Alternatively, the system update program may be invalid.	Use the correct program to perform the update once again. If this does not solve the problem, contact your dealer or customer support.
Now Playing!	Since the TR-8S is playing, this operation cannot be executed.	Stop playback before you execute the operation.
Now Recording!	Since the TR-8S is recording, this operation cannot be executed.	Stop recording before you execute the operation.
Not Found!	The file was not found on the SD card.	Make sure that the file exists on the SD card.

Main Specifications

Roland TR-8S: RHYTHM PERFORMER

Power Supply	AC Adaptor
Current Draw	2,000 mA
Dimensions	409 (W) x 263 (D) x 58 (H) mm
	16-1/8 (W) x 10-3/8 (D) x 2-5/16 (H) inches
Weight	2.1 kg/4 lbs 11 oz
Accessories	AC adaptor, Owner's manual, Leaflet "USING THE UNIT SAFELY"

* This document explains the specifications of the product at the time that the document was issued. For the latest information, refer to the Roland website.